

Module 3: Religion, Ethics, and Migration

Service Learning Project

Hospitality in Practice: Serving with a Faith-Based Welcome Ministry

Overview

Serve alongside a faith-based or interfaith organization that welcomes migrants, and analyze how ethical and religious frameworks from the module show up — or don't — in day-to-day practice.

Aligned learning outcomes

- Describe ethical perspectives on migration as enacted in practice (UG 1)
- Explain religious influences on migration response (UG 2)
- Analyze moral dilemmas that arise in real service settings (UG 3)

Suggested community partners

- Catholic Charities or diocesan migrant ministries
- Interfaith refugee co-sponsorship circles
- Congregation-based ESL, accompaniment, or hospitality programs
- Campus ministry service programs focused on newcomers

Project steps

1. Complete partner orientation and read the partner's mission/values statements.
2. Serve at least four sessions in a hospitality role (meal programs, ESL support, accompaniment, donation organizing).
3. Keep a field journal linking observed practices to module frameworks (hospitality vs. exclusion, Catholic social teaching, ethics of welcome).
4. Identify one real moral dilemma you observed or heard about (de-identified) and analyze it with two ethical frameworks from the module.
5. Discuss your analysis with a staff member or volunteer coordinator for their practitioner perspective.
6. Write the final case analysis and share a summary with the partner if they wish.

Deliverables

- Field journal (4+ entries)
- Ethical dilemma case analysis (3–4 pages) using two frameworks
- One-page practitioner-perspective summary

Time commitment

14–16 hours.

Ethics requirements

Students of all faiths and none participate as learners and helpers, not evangelists; respect the partner's community norms.

Grading rubric

Each criterion is scored at one of four levels, then weighted as shown. The overall grade is the weighted combination of criterion scores. Instructors may adapt weights and descriptors to local requirements.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Reliable, respectful service participation 25%	Conduct is impeccable: reliable, respectful service participation is demonstrated throughout, protocols are followed without exception, and the work shows active care for the people and communities involved.	Conduct is sound: reliable, respectful service participation is evident with only minor lapses that do not affect participants or partners, and all required protocols are followed.	Conduct is uneven: reliable, respectful service participation is addressed but with gaps — a missed protocol step, careless handling of sensitive material, or boundary issues requiring instructor follow-up.	Conduct falls short of requirements: reliable, respectful service participation is neglected in ways that required intervention or placed participants, partners, or material at risk.
Accurate use of ethical and religious frameworks 30%	Evidence and accuracy are exemplary: accurate use of ethical and religious frameworks is met with high-quality, correctly cited sources for every substantive claim; terms, facts, and frameworks are used precisely.	Evidence and accuracy are solid: accurate use of ethical and religious frameworks is met for nearly all claims, with only minor sourcing gaps or imprecisions that do not affect conclusions.	Evidence and accuracy are uneven: accurate use of ethical and religious frameworks is partly met — some claims lack support, sources are thin or misread, or terms are used loosely in ways that weaken conclusions.	Evidence and accuracy are deficient: accurate use of ethical and religious frameworks is not met; key claims are unsupported or wrong, and errors undermine the work's conclusions.
Quality of the dilemma analysis — genuine tension, not a straw man 30%	Analysis is genuinely insightful: quality of the dilemma analysis — genuine tension, not a straw man goes beyond summary to produce non-obvious, well-defended conclusions; concepts are applied accurately, complexity is preserved, and counterpoints are engaged seriously.	Analysis is competent: quality of the dilemma analysis — genuine tension, not a straw man is achieved with clear reasoning and accurate use of course concepts, though conclusions stay near the expected.	Analysis is thin: quality of the dilemma analysis — genuine tension, not a straw man is attempted but leans on summary or assertion; concepts are named more than used, and complications are avoided.	Analysis is absent: quality of the dilemma analysis — genuine tension, not a straw man is not achieved; the work describes without analyzing or draws conclusions its own material does not support.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Integration of the practitioner's perspective 15%	Analysis is genuinely insightful: integration of the practitioner's perspective goes beyond summary to produce non-obvious, well-defended conclusions; concepts are applied accurately, complexity is preserved, and counterpoints are engaged seriously.	Analysis is competent: integration of the practitioner's perspective is achieved with clear reasoning and accurate use of course concepts, though conclusions stay near the expected.	Analysis is thin: integration of the practitioner's perspective is attempted but leans on summary or assertion; concepts are named more than used, and complications are avoided.	Analysis is absent: integration of the practitioner's perspective is not achieved; the work describes without analyzing or draws conclusions its own material does not support.